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Arcane FX

Issue #001

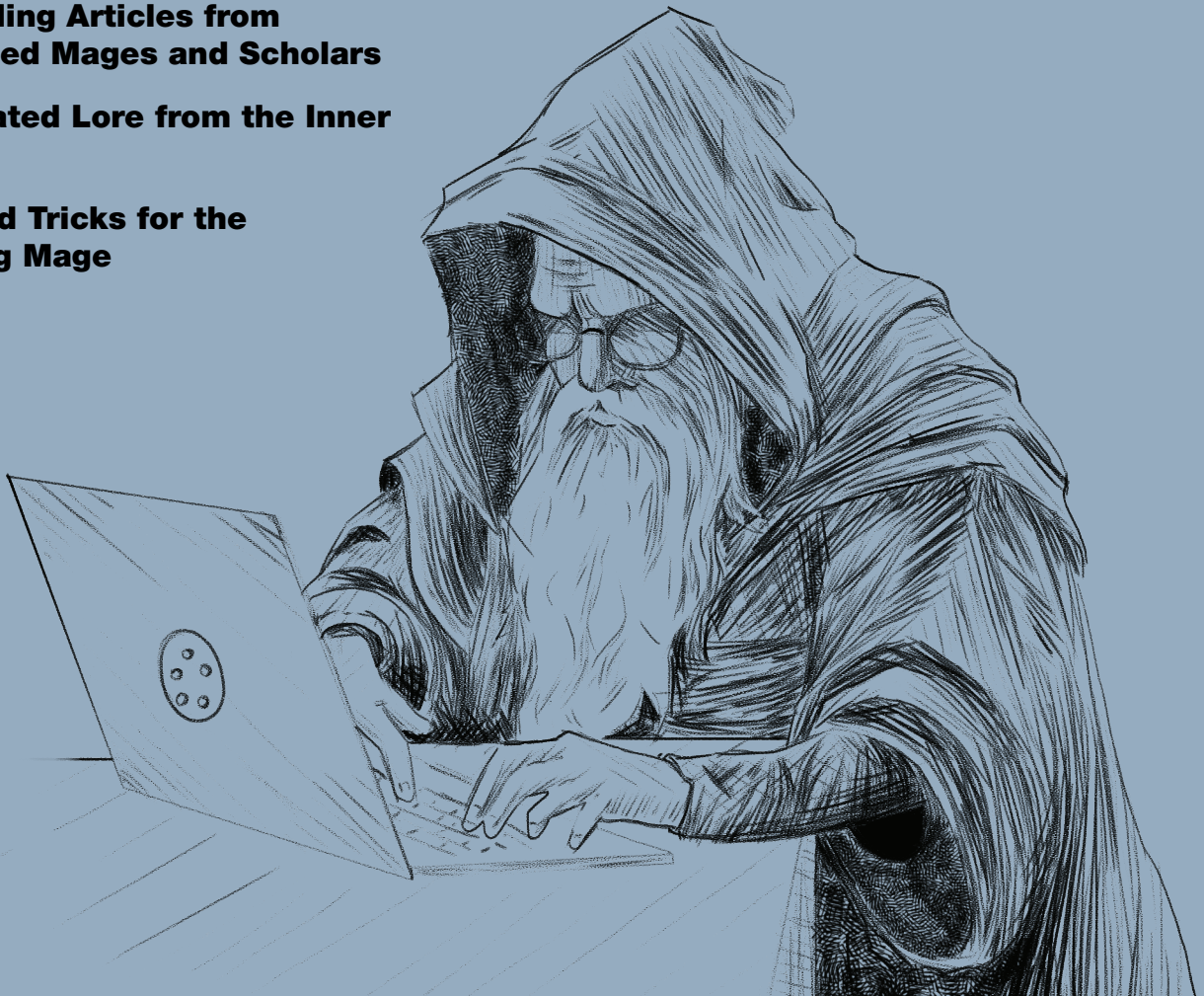
May 28th, 2024

THE ANCIENT PUBLICATION MAKES ITS DEBUT IN THE DIGITAL AGE!

**Enthralling Articles from
Esteemed Mages and Scholars**

**Illuminated Lore from the Inner
Planes**

**Tips and Tricks for the
Aspiring Mage**



Letter From the Editor

James R Mann
Editor-in-Chief
Arcane Magazine

Dear Esteemed Readers,

As we embark on another thrilling edition of Arcane Magazine, I am thrilled to welcome you to a realm of boundless wonder and discovery. With each issue, our goal is to ignite the spark of creativity within you, guiding you through the intricate tapestry of tabletop gaming and inspiring you to weave your own tales of magic and adventure.

In this edition, we have delved deep into the enigmatic Astral Plane, peeling back the layers of mystery to reveal its ethereal beauty and cosmic wonders. From the echoing chambers of ancient Githyanki fortresses to the serene tranquility of astral gardens, we have endeavored to capture the essence of this otherworldly realm and provide you with the tools and insights to explore its depths in your own campaigns.

But our journey does not end there. We have also delved into the art of battlemat design, shining a light on the talented creators and artisans whose intricate designs bring the worlds of tabletop gaming to life in vivid detail. From the sprawling cityscapes of Caeora to the labyrinthine dungeons of Dyson Logos, their creations are a testament to the power of imagination and the boundless possibilities of the tabletop.

As we continue to navigate the ever-changing landscape of tabletop gaming, I invite you to join us on this magical journey. Whether you are a seasoned veteran or a novice apprentice, Arcane Magazine is your guide in the quest for knowledge, creativity, and adventure. So gather your party, sharpen your wits, and let the magic unfold!

Yours in the pursuit of the arcane,



A New Era of Arcane

On the Transition to Digital

As the world of magic and technology continues to evolve, so too does Arcane Magazine. With the rise of digital platforms and the ever-increasing accessibility of online content, Arcane has made the bold decision to transition from print to a fully digital format. This transition allows us to reach a wider audience of wizards and enthusiasts, offering instant access to our wealth of articles, tutorials, and resources at the click of a button. Embracing the digital realm enables us to incorporate interactive features, multimedia content, and real-time updates, providing a more immersive and dynamic reading experience for our readers. While we bid farewell to the rustle of parchment and the scent of ink, we welcome a new era of innovation and connectivity, where the magic of Arcane knows no bounds.

Whats Next for Arcane?

we are committed to pushing the boundaries of magical innovation even further. Our goal is to continue providing valuable insights, inspiration, and resources to empower wizards in their pursuit of knowledge and mastery. With exciting developments on the horizon, the future of Arcane is brighter and more enchanting than ever before.

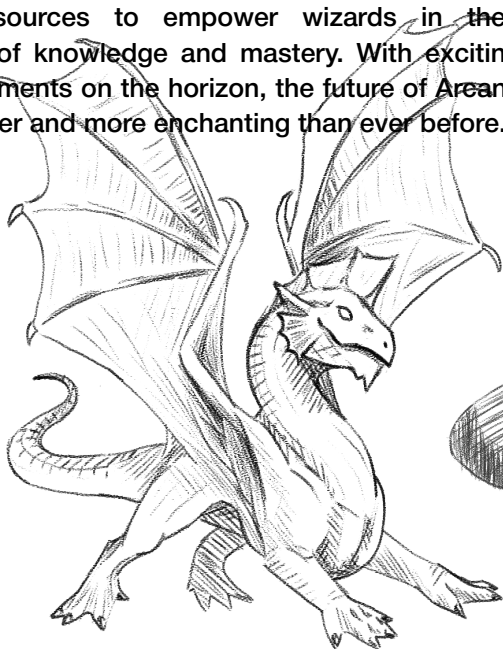


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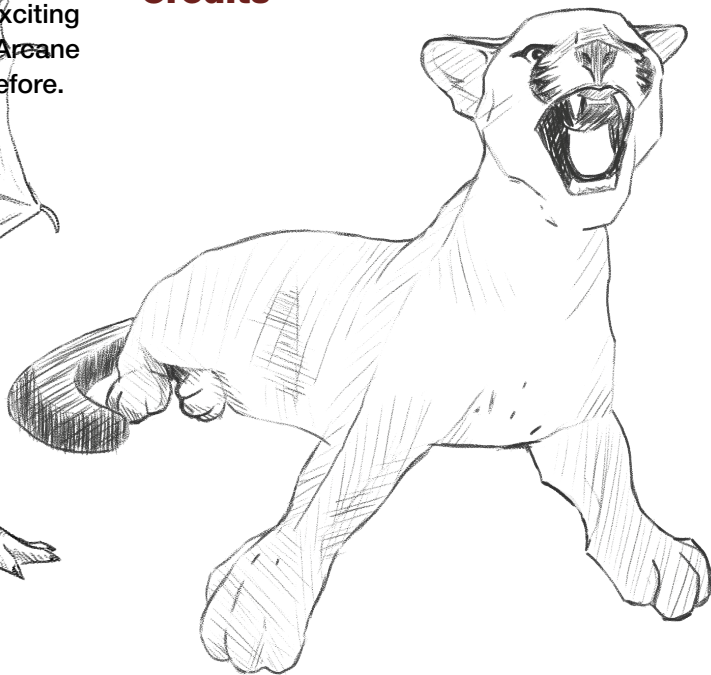
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Credits



Treatsies

Introduction

From the Editor

In this era of enchanted innovation, where arcane lore and digital prowess converge, the wizard stands at the threshold of boundless possibilities. As spells are woven and the threads of magic manipulated, the emergence of virtual realms transcends the confines of parchment and quill.

With each incantation uttered and tome consulted, the wizard delves into the depths of digital sorcery, navigating the intricate web of virtual tabletops and crafting wondrous items with but a flick of the wrist. From the sanctum of the study, the wizard peers into the ether, where realms of imagination manifest in pixels and code, beckoning adventurers to embark on epic quests.

As a seeker of knowledge and a guardian of arcane secrets, the wizard offers guidance to fellow travelers, illuminating the path through the ever-expanding landscape of tabletop gaming. For in

this age of technological marvels, where the arcane and the digital intertwine, the possibilities are as

infinite as the stars themselves.

How to Use this Magazine

From the Editor

This Publication is intended to be used by Dm's to spark ideas for their own games and settings. We at Arcane FX encourage you to adapt the content herein to suit your particular needs. The information in this magazine builds upon the Dnd 5e source books, such as the Monster Manual, Fizbans Treasury of Dragons, and Xanathars Guide. These books and more are available for purchase at Dndbeyond.com.

Crafting Magic

Navigating D&D's Crafting Rules

In the realms of Dungeons & Dragons, magic items are more than just enchanted trinkets; they're artifacts of power, imbued with the essence of the fantastical worlds they inhabit. Crafting these wondrous items is a pursuit as old as the arcane itself, blending skill, knowledge, and sometimes a dash of luck. Yet, within the vast tapestry of D&D rulebooks, crafting magical items can seem as complex and mysterious as the spells they contain.

Both the DMG and Xanathar's Guide offer aspiring artisans a roadmap to create magical wonders during downtime, presenting rules that govern the process with varying degrees of detail and flexibility. As one forum contributor keenly observes:

"Both the DMG and Xanathar's guide offer rules for creating magical items during down time with some elements consistent throughout... They do however, seem to contradict some points and neglect others entirely."

- NoSweetClue, D&DBeyond forums,
Apr 2021.

The DMG lays down a stringent set of prerequisites that a character must fulfill before delving into the craft. These requirements encompass not only proficiency in the tools and skills relevant to the item's creation but also demand a certain level of proficiency and access to rare materials and spells. Conversely, Xanathar's Guide takes a more liberal approach, eschewing these prerequisites in favor of a streamlined process, focusing primarily on the expenditure of time and gold.

However, contradictions emerge between the two tomes. The DMG adopts an incremental timescale for crafting, where progress unfolds gradually over time, akin to a labor of love. In contrast, Xanathar's Guide imposes a fixed timescale, compressing the crafting process into a

defined period. This clash of temporal paradigms can prove vexing for adventurers blessed with abilities that accelerate crafting or reduce the required resources, casting shadows of ambiguity over the crafting table.

CRAFTING MAGIC ITEMS

Item Rarity	Creation Cost	Minimum Level
Common	100 gp	3rd
Uncommon	500 gp	3rd
Rare	5,000 gp	6th
Very rare	50,000 gp	11th
Legendary	500,000 gp	17th

An item has a creation cost specified in the Crafting Magic Items table. A character engaged in the crafting of a magic item makes progress in 25 gp increments, spending that amount for each day of work until the total cost is paid. The character is assumed to work for 8 hours each of those days. Thus, creating an uncommon magic item takes 20 days and 500 gp. You are free to adjust the costs to better suit your campaign.

DMG pg. 129

Moreover, the forum contributor highlights a crucial oversight within the annals of crafting rules: the disparity between the rules and the capabilities of certain classes, notably artificers. Xanathar's Guide, by its nature, extends a welcoming hand to these would-be artisans, granting them the ability to not only craft but also wield powerful items. In doing so, it bridges a gap left by the DMG, where such empowerment remains unacknowledged.

Ultimately, the choice between the DMG and Xanathar's Guide becomes a matter of preference and narrative coherence. The DMG offers a rich, immersive experience, where the journey of crafting unfolds organically, mirroring the ebbs and flows of the adventurer's life. Conversely, Xanathar's Guide provides a more expedient path, ideal for those seeking efficiency without sacrificing the mystique of magic.

A character needs to be proficient with the tools needed to craft an item and have access to the appropriate equipment. Everyone who collaborates needs to have the appropriate tool proficiency. You need to make any judgment calls regarding whether a character has the correct equipment. The following table provides some examples.

Proficiency	Items
Herbalism kit	Antitoxin, <i>potion of healing</i>
Leatherworker's tools	Leather armor, boots
Smith's tools	Armor, weapons
Weaver's tools	Cloaks, robes

If all the above requirements are met, the result of the process is an item of the desired sort. A character can sell an item crafted in this way at its listed price.

Crafting Magic Items. Creating a magic item requires more than just time, effort, and materials. It is a long-term process that involves one or more adventures to track down rare materials and the lore needed to create the item.

XGE pg. 129

Magic is a powerful force in the realms of fantasy, capable of shaping worlds, altering destinies, and influencing the course of history. Yet, with such power comes great responsibility, and the ethical implications of magic use are often complex and multifaceted. In this article, we embark on a journey into the moral gray areas of magic, exploring the ethical dilemmas, philosophical questions, and roleplaying opportunities that arise when characters wield the forces of the arcane.

Alignment is a fundamental aspect of character creation in Dungeons & Dragons, serving as a moral compass that guides a character's actions and beliefs. Often depicted as a two-dimensional grid encompassing nine distinct moral and ethical alignments, the concept of alignment raises questions about the nature of good and evil, law and chaos, and the role of morality in a fantasy world. In this article, we delve into the intricacies of alignment in D&D, exploring its implications for character development, roleplaying opportunities,

and storytelling in tabletop adventures.

In the world of roleplaying games, characters are often faced with difficult choices that test their moral compass and force them to consider the consequences of their actions. From the temptation to use dark and forbidden magic to the ethical implications of mind-controlling spells, players must navigate a minefield of ethical dilemmas that blur the lines between right and wrong. By engaging with these dilemmas in their roleplaying sessions, players can explore complex moral themes and challenge their own preconceptions about morality and magic.

One of the most compelling aspects of exploring the morality of magic in roleplaying games is the opportunity for rich character development and storytelling. Characters who grapple with ethical dilemmas and moral quandaries are more than just adventurers – they are complex individuals with hopes, fears, and inner conflicts that drive their actions and shape their destinies. By embracing these opportunities for roleplaying, players can deepen their connection to their characters and create memorable moments that resonate long after the game has ended.

	Good	Neutral	Evil
Lawful	Lawful Good	Lawful Neutral	Lawful Evil
Neutral	Neutral Good	True Neutral	Neutral Evil
Chaotic	Chaotic Good	Chaotic Neutral	Chaotic Evil

VTT's:

The Ultimate Guide to Platforms for Remote Play

As the TTRPG community increasingly embraces online connectivity, virtual tabletops (VTTs) have become essential tools for remote tabletop gaming enthusiasts. From Roll20 to Foundry Virtual Tabletop, selecting the right VTT can be daunting. In this article, we'll explore the top VTTs, highlighting their features, usability, and suitability for various gaming styles, to help you make an informed choice for your next virtual gaming session.

In their article, **How to Play D&D Online Using VTTs**, written by Duncan of [Hipstersanddragons.com](https://hipstersanddragons.com), the authors delve into available virtual tabletops (VTT) options and their role in modern tabletop gaming.

"Different virtual tabletops will suit different groups, and it may take exploring a handful of them before you find one that matches both your playstyle and your price point."

*Duncan, Hipstersanddragons.com,
November 2021*

Explore the strengths and weaknesses of leading virtual tabletops (VTTs) as we compare each platform's pros and cons.

Roleplaying

The Art of Immersion

Roleplaying is at the heart of tabletop gaming, allowing players to step into the shoes of their characters and immerse themselves in fantastical worlds of adventure and intrigue. While the mechanics of the game provide structure and rules, it is the art of roleplaying that breathes life into these characters, turning them from mere avatars on a character sheet into vibrant personalities with hopes, dreams, and fears. In this article, we'll explore the nuances of roleplaying and provide tips and techniques to help players deepen their character immersion and elevate their tabletop experience.

The first step in enhancing character immersion is to develop a rich and detailed backstory for your character. Think about where they come from, what events shaped their past, and what motivates them to embark on their current journey. By understanding your character's history and motivations, you can better embody their personality and make more informed decisions during gameplay. Don't be afraid to get creative and think outside the box – the more depth and complexity you add to your character's backstory, the more immersive your roleplaying experience will be.

Once you have a solid understanding of your character's backstory, it's time to bring them to life at the gaming table. One of the most effective ways to do this is by fully embodying your character's personality traits, quirks, and mannerisms. Pay attention to how your character would react in different situations, and try to stay true to their unique personality throughout the game. Whether they're a brave and noble hero or a cunning and conniving rogue, staying in character adds depth and authenticity to your roleplaying experience.

In addition to embodying your character's personality, don't forget to engage with the other players at the table and build meaningful

relationships with their characters. Take the time to listen to their stories, offer support and encouragement, and collaborate on shared goals and objectives. By forging strong bonds with your fellow players, you'll not only enhance the overall gameplay experience but also create memorable moments and meaningful connections that will last long after the game has ended.

Finally, remember that roleplaying is a collaborative effort, and the most important thing is to have fun and enjoy the journey. Don't be afraid to take risks, try new things, and push the boundaries of your character's capabilities. Embrace the challenges and obstacles that come your way, and use them as opportunities for growth and character development. Whether you're delving into ancient dungeons, battling fearsome monsters, or unraveling sinister plots, let your imagination run wild and allow yourself to fully immerse in the rich and vibrant world of tabletop gaming.

For more Roleplaying guidance check out [XP to Level 3's](#) video 'How to be Better at Roleplaying in D&D'.

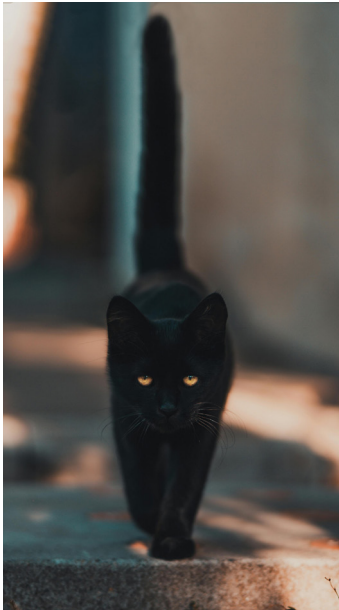


[How to be Better at Roleplaying in D&D](#)

Conjuring Companions

Summoning Familiars and animal companions

In the world of magic, the bond between a spellcaster and their familiar or animal companion is a sacred and powerful connection. Whether it's a wise owl perched on a wizard's shoulder or a loyal wolf at a ranger's side, these companions play an integral role in shaping the narrative of tabletop adventures. In this article, we delve into the intricacies of summoning and bonding with familiars and animal companions, exploring the mechanics, roleplaying opportunities, and potential for storytelling that these magical creatures offer.



Black Cat Walking on Board, David Bartus

Familiars are more than just ordinary animals – they are magical beings bound to the service of a spellcaster through arcane rituals and pacts. Wizards often summon familiars to aid them in

their magical endeavors, granting them additional abilities and enhancing their spellcasting prowess. From the clever and intuitive cat to the mysterious and otherworldly raven, familiars come in many forms, each with its own unique strengths and abilities. As a spellcaster, it is essential to cultivate a strong bond with your familiar, treating them with care and respect, and nurturing the connection between you.



Gray Owl Perched on a Tree Stamp, Pixabay

For rangers, druids, and other nature-focused characters, the bond with an animal companion is a natural extension of their connection to the wilderness. These loyal creatures serve as steadfast allies and guardians, accompanying their masters on daring adventures and offering invaluable support in times of need. When summoning an animal companion, it is crucial to choose a creature that aligns with your character's ethos and personality, fostering a deep and lasting bond that transcends

mere obedience. Through training, communication, and mutual respect, the bond between a character and their animal companion can grow stronger with each passing adventure, resulting in a partnership that is as enduring as it is magical.

Roleplaying Opportunities

The relationship between a spellcaster and their familiar or a character and their animal companion presents a myriad of roleplaying opportunities that can enrich the tabletop experience. From playful banter and shared secrets to silent understanding and unspoken gestures, the interactions between these companions can add depth and nuance to character interactions and storytelling. By embracing the unique personalities and quirks of their companions, players can breathe life into their characters and create memorable moments that resonate long after the game has ended.

Conclusion

Whether you're a wizard seeking a wise and cunning familiar or a ranger in search of a loyal and steadfast companion, the bond between a spellcaster and their magical creature is a powerful and transformative experience. By embracing the mechanics, roleplaying opportunities, and storytelling potential of familiars and animal companions, players can enrich their tabletop adventures and forge lasting connections that transcend the boundaries of magic and reality. So summon your companions, embark on daring quests, and let the magic of companionship guide you on your journey through the realms of fantasy.



Black Bird Perching, Tim Mossholder

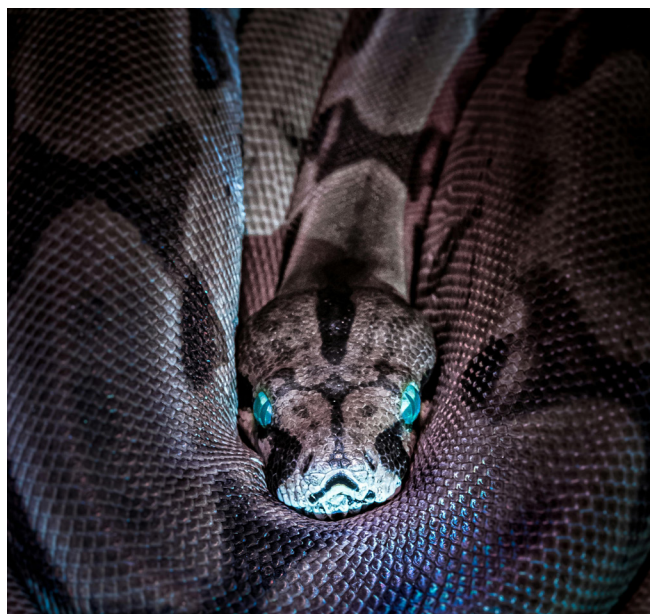


Photo of Snake, Jan Kopřiva

Codex

Introduction

From the Editor

Welcome to the Codex, a curated collection of knowledge and inspiration for the discerning wizard. Within these pages, you'll find a treasure trove of articles, essays, and insights that delve into the arcane arts and the wonders of the digital age. From spellcasting techniques to crafting magical artifacts, the Codex offers a wealth of resources to spark your imagination and elevate your wizardry to new heights. Whether you're a seasoned practitioner or a fledgling mage, join us on a journey through the realms of magic and technology, where endless possibilities await.

The Forgotten Realms

The Forgotten Realms is a vast and richly detailed campaign setting for the Dungeons & Dragons role-playing game, offering players and

Dungeon Masters a sprawling canvas on which to weave their tales of adventure and heroism. Set in a world of high fantasy, The Forgotten Realms encompasses countless realms, kingdoms, and cities, each with its own unique history, cultures, and inhabitants. From the towering spires of Waterdeep to the ancient forests of the High Forest, and from the sun-scorched deserts of Calimshan to the icy tundras of Icewind Dale, the realms are filled with untold wonders and dangers awaiting discovery.

Nestled within The Forgotten Realms is the enigmatic Astral Plane, a mystical dimension where the fabric of magic and reality intertwines. Within this ethereal expanse, silver mists and twinkling starlight coalesce to form a realm of ever-shifting beauty and boundless potential. It is a realm of infinite possibility, where ethereal citadels float amidst the void, and cosmic entities drift like celestial specters. The Astral Plane beckons adventurers with promises of discovery and peril, offering glimpses into the very fabric of existence itself.

The Inner Planes

Both the DMG and Xanathar's Guide offer aspiring artisans a roadmap to create magical wonders during downtime, presenting rules that govern the process with varying degrees of detail and flexibility. From the Forgotten Realms Wiki:

"The Inner Planes contained environments that were among the most hostile in the multiverse. Unlike the Outer Planes, which were built on belief and thought, the Inner Planes were the manifestation of central aspects of physical reality. As a result of this intense concentration of reality, everything in the Inner Planes, including its inhabitants, felt more vivid and intense, while at the same time more indifferent."



Hubble Spots a Magnificent Barred Galaxy, ESA/Hubble & NASA, J. Dalcanton

The Astral Plane

Both the DMG and Xanathar's Guide offer aspiring artisans a roadmap to create magical wonders during downtime, presenting rules that govern the process with varying degrees of detail and flexibility. From the Forgotten Realms Wiki:

"The Astral could be reached from almost any point in a Prime Material plane or first layer of any Outer plane by spell, psionic ability, or device. It was described as a barren place of other-dimensional nothingness extending in all directions. What little solid substance that floated in the bright, gray void was typically chunks of matter broken off from their original plane. The Astral had no gravity but objects did retain their mass so you could throw small items or push off from large objects to move in the weightless environment.

Time in the Astral flowed at the same rate on a Prime Material plane but the effects of time were slowed almost to a stop—a thousand years in the Astral plane felt like only a day to the traveler. Hence, it was sometimes considered effectively timeless. Creatures did not go hungry or age while in the Astral plane. For that reason, its mortal inhabitants needed to return to the Material Plane in order to have children or to reach adulthood.

Entering the Astral plane could be accomplished in one of two ways: projecting your astral form into the plane via the astral projection spell, or by physically entering the plane. Astral projection was the safest way to travel but still involved risk because you left your physical body behind on the traveler's plane of origin. The astral body would be accompanied by the astral forms of any items and clothing that were magical or radiated a magic aura. While projecting, your astral self was connected to your physical body by a silver cord that stretched out behind you for about 10 feet (3 meters), or 1 foot (30 centimeters) depending on the version of the spell, and then became invisible and intangible."

Who's House?

In the University of Houston setting

Shasta the Cougar serves as both a symbolic figure and a practical element within the University of Houston setting. Players might encounter her as they navigate the campus, where her presence adds depth to the environment and enhances immersion. As a symbol of the university's spirit, Shasta could be incorporated into quests or storylines that involve protecting or preserving the institution. Players might seek her out for guidance or assistance, leveraging her knowledge of the campus grounds to overcome challenges or uncover secrets.

Additionally, Shasta could serve as a quest giver or quest objective, with players tasked to aid or interact with her in some way. This could involve tasks such as locating lost artifacts hidden within the campus or protecting Shasta from outside threats. Alternatively, she might serve as a companion or ally to the players, offering assistance in their adventures or providing valuable information about the surrounding area. Overall, Shasta the Cougar adds depth and flavor to the game world, enriching the player experience with her presence and significance within the University of Houston setting.

Shasta the Cougar

Medium Beast, Neutral Good
Armor Class: 14 (Natural Armor)
Hit Points: average: 52 (7d10+14)
Speed: 40 ft

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	16 (+3)	15 (+2)	8 (-1)	12(+1)	16(+3)

Saving Throws: Cha +5, Dex +5
Skills: Athletics +6, Performance +5
Senses: passive Perception 13
Languages: Understands Common
Challenge: 3 Proficiency Bonus: +2

Keen Smell: Shasta has advantage on Perception Checks that rely on smell.

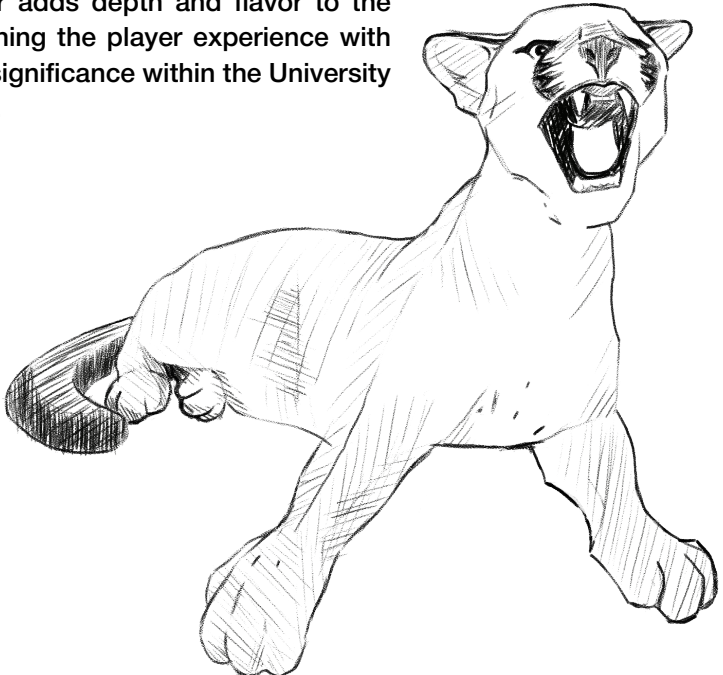
Pounce: If Shasta moves 20 ft or more in a straight line towards a large or smaller creature and then hits it with a claw attack, the creature must succeed on a DC 14 Str Save or be knocked prone. Shasta can make one bite attack against the prone creature.

Bounding Leap: With a 10 ft running start, Shasta may jump up to 25 feet horizontally or vertically.

Actions

Bite: Melee Weapon Attack, +6 to hit, 9 (1d10+4) piercing damage

Claw: Melee Weapon Attack, +6 to hit, 8 (1d8+4) piercing damage



Explorering the Inner Planes

Navigating the Astral Sea

In Dungeons & Dragons 5th Edition, navigating the Astral Sea is a daring endeavor undertaken by intrepid adventurers aboard spelljamming vessels. As they traverse the ethereal currents of this otherworldly realm, explorers encounter a tapestry of celestial wonders, from shimmering starfields to drifting islands of solidified thought. Guided by the arcane energies of their vessels, adventurers chart a course through the Astral Sea, braving the perils of astral predators and rival factions vying for control of the boundless expanse. With each voyage, they uncover secrets hidden within the fabric of reality itself, forging a path through the mysteries of the cosmos.

For more information on spelljamming and the astral sea seek the [Astral Adventurer's Guide](#), [Mordenkainen's Tome of Foes](#), and [Xanathar's Guide to Everything](#)

Adrift In a Sea of Dangers

Spelljamming through the Astral Plane presents adventurers with a myriad of dangers lurking within its shimmering expanse. As vessels traverse the ethereal currents, they may encounter astral predators, entities born of pure thought hungering for the essence of travelers. The unpredictability of the Astral Sea itself poses hazards, with travelers risking becoming lost in the ever-shifting mists or ensnared by the psychic remnants of long-forgotten battles. Furthermore, rival factions and cosmic entities vie for control, leading to potential conflicts that can escalate swiftly amidst the boundless expanse of the astral void. Surviving the perils of spelljamming in the Astral Plane demands vigilance, courage, and an unwavering resolve to navigate the treacherous seas of the cosmos.

Silver Elf Sorcerer

Medium Humanoid (Astral Elf), Lawfull Evil

Armor Class: 17 (Silk)
Hit Points: 50 (8d6+16)
Speed: walk, swim, fly(tag)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	18 (+4)	16 (+3)	16 (+3)	11(+0)	20(+5)

Saving Throws: Int +6, Cha +8
Skills: Stealth +7, Deception +8, Arcana +5
Resistances: Cold
Immunities:
Senses: Darkvision 60 ft
Languages: Common, Elvish, Draconic
Challenge: 6 **Proficiency Bonus:** +3

Metamagic. The Silver Elf has 9 Sorcery Points, and the metamagic options Empowerd spell, Quickenened spell, Transmuted spell

Dragon Binder. Silver Elf sorcerers may summon an Oath Bound Silver Dragon as a 5th level spell. It functions as the fith level spell [Summon Draconic Spirit](#) but uses the Oathbound Silver Dragon Statblock

Variant: Draconic Familiar. For added challenge let the Silver Elf summon the Oathbound Silver Dragon as a familiar, via the find familiar spell.

[Gift of the Mettalic Dragon*](#)

Actions

Dagger. Melee Attack, +7 to hit, 6 (1d4+4 piercing)
Longbow. Ranged Attack, +7 to hit, 8 (1d8+4 piercing)

Spellcasting

The Silver Elf is a 9th level sorcerer, its spellcasting ability is charisma (Spell Attack: +8, Spell Save DC: 16) It has the following spells prepared:

Cantrips (at will). Frost Bite, Lightning Lure, Mlnor Illusion, Ray of Frost

1st Level (4 slots). Cure Wounds (1 slot), Chaos Bolt, Frost Fingers, Sheild, Chromatic Orb

2nd Level (3 slots). Dragons Breath, Misty Step

3rd Level (3 slots). Fireball

4th Level (3 slots). Dimension Door

5th Level (1 slots). Cone of Cold

References

*FTD pg. 17 - [Wikidot](#)

Description

Silver astral elf sorcerers possess an otherworldly

allure, with silver hair cascading like moonlight and pale, almost luminous skin reminiscent of starlight. They often don flowing robes of light blue silk, which shimmer with arcane energy as they move.

In the Planes

Silver Astral elves hail from The Twilight Meadow, a village hidden in the Astral Sea. The glittering mists surrounding the hidden villages can only be navigated by magical means. The Elves of The Twilight Meadow once harvested Silver Metal from the Great Elms that shaded their land, but the secret was lost and the Silver Astral Elves have since turned to piracy, and slavery to fuel their magic.

Dragon Binding
An Ancient Bond...

Legends speak of the ancient bond between Silver Elf Sorcerers and the majestic silver dragons, a connection forged in antiquity. Through rituals steeped in arcane mysticism, these sorcerers tap into the primordial energies of the cosmos, establishing a psychic link with the noble silver dragons that soar through the Astral Sea. In this symbiotic union, the sorcerer acts as a conduit for the dragon’s boundless wisdom and strength, while the dragon finds solace and purpose in serving as a guardian and ally to their elven kin. Together, they embody the harmony of the celestial order, weaving spells and shaping destinies in the name of cosmic balance.

Long ago, a dark corruption tainted the sacred bond between Silver Elf Sorcerers and silver dragons. Driven by ambition and thirst for power, some sorcerers delved into forbidden magics, twisting the once-pure connection into a tool of domination. Through ancient rituals and dark pacts, they bound silver dragons to their will, bending them to serve their nefarious desires. As the ages passed, the echoes of this corruption reverberate

through the Astral Plane, casting a shadow over the once-harmonious relationship.

Oath Bound Silver Dragon
Small Construct Dragon, Lawfull Good

Armor Class: 17 (natural armor)
Hit Points: 45 (6d8+18)
Speed: 10 ft, 60 ft fly

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	17 (+3)	17 (+3)	12 (+1)	11(+0)	15(+2)

Saving Throws: Dex +5,
Skills: Arcana +3, Perception +2, Stealth +5
Resistances:
Immunities: Cold
Senses: Darkvision
Languages: Draconic, understands but does not speak:
Common, the languages you speak.
Challenge: 3 **Proficiency Bonus:** +2

Magic resistance. The dragon has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.

Familiar. The DM may allow a player to have this creature as a familiar, as defined by the firs level spell [find familiar](#) spell. The dragon may still make attack rolls, but can not be dismissed or changed into another shape by the find familiar spell.

- Variant: Silver Dragon Wyrmling*
- Gift of the Mettalic Dragon**
- Variant: Dragons as Innate Spellcasters***

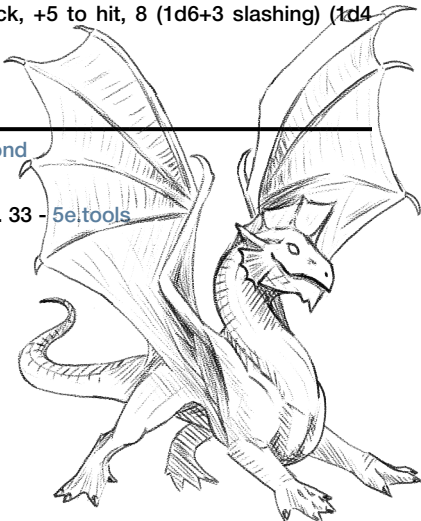
Actions

Multiattack. The Silver Dragon can make two twinblade attacks with its action.

Twinblade. Melee Attack, +5 to hit, 8 (1d6+3 slashing) (1d4 cold)

References

- *MM pg. 118 - [Dnd Byond](#)
- **FTD pg. 17 - [Wikidot](#)
- ***MM pg. 118, FTD pg. 33 - [5e.tools](#)



Appendix

Introduction

Intro subtitle

In the Appendix section of Arcane Magazine, we delve deeper into the realms of fantasy, providing additional resources, tools, and references to enhance your tabletop gaming experience. Here, you'll find supplementary materials such as character sheets, spell lists, and creature stat blocks, as well as handy guides and charts to aid you in your adventures. Whether you're a dungeon master seeking to enrich your campaign world or a player looking for additional resources to enhance your character, the Appendix is your repository of invaluable resources and aids. So dive in, explore its contents, and unlock new possibilities in your tabletop adventures!

Battlemaps and Tokens

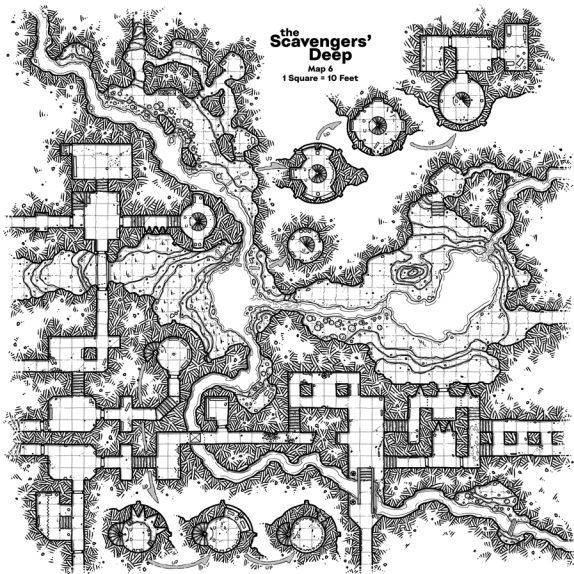
From sprawling dungeons to epic landscapes, battlemaps serve as the canvas upon which your encounters come to life. In this segment, we delve into tips, techniques, and tools to help you craft dynamic and engaging battlemaps that will captivate your players and elevate your gaming experience. Whether you're a seasoned cartographer or a novice dungeon master, join us as we embark on a journey through the world of battlemap design.

Dyson Logos

Dyson Logos, a renowned artist and cartographer who crafts captivating battlemaps that ignite the imagination of dungeon masters and players alike. Through his [Patreon](#) platform, Dyson shares his intricate designs, many at no cost. Ranging from labyrinthine dungeons to sprawling cityscapes, with a global community of tabletop enthusiasts. His signature style blends classic fantasy elements

with meticulous attention to detail, bringing each map to life with a sense of depth and immersion.

The Pumpking, Caeora



Scavengers Deep 6, Dyson Logos

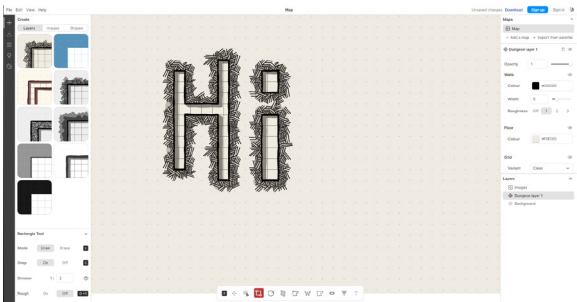
Caeora

Caeora creates battlemaps, tokens, and creature cards that breathe life into the worlds of tabletop gaming. Through platforms like Patreon and other digital marketplaces, Caeora shares their expansive collection of meticulously crafted assets on their Patreon, where a selection of their work is provided at no cost.



Dungeonscrawl

Dungeonscrawl, a user-friendly web app enabling dungeon masters and players to craft custom battlemaps effortlessly. With intuitive drag-and-drop functionality and a vast library of assets, Dungeonscrawl streamlines map creation for any tabletop adventure. Whether designing intricate dungeons or expansive landscapes, this versatile tool empowers users to bring their visions to life and enhance their gaming experiences with ease.



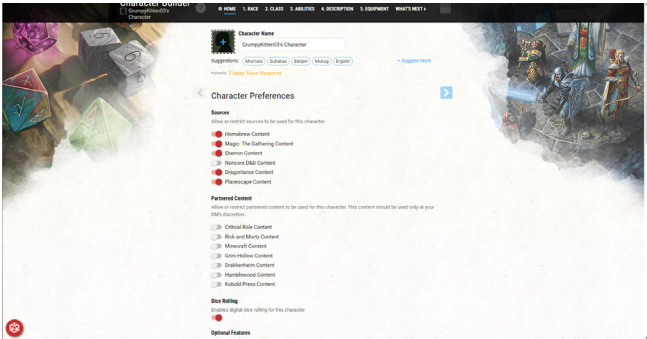
Character Sheets

Character sheets are the foundation of every player's journey into the realms of fantasy, serving as a canvas upon which their adventures unfold. In this section of the Appendix, you'll find printable templates meticulously designed to help you bring your characters to life. Whether you're a seasoned adventurer or a newcomer to the world of tabletop gaming, these character sheets provide a structured framework for tracking your stats, abilities, and equipment, allowing you to immerse yourself fully in the role of your chosen hero. So grab your quill, fill in your details, and embark on a quest of epic proportions with these essential tools at your side.

D&D Beyond

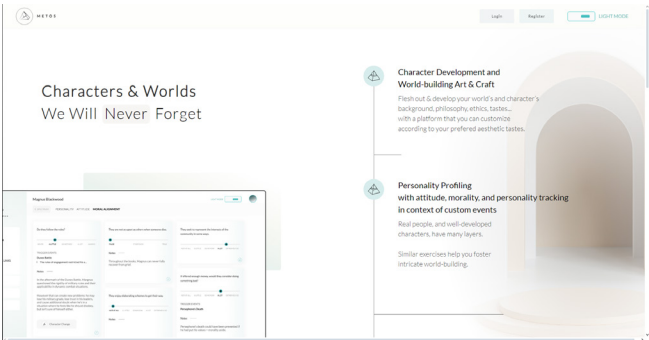
For those adventurers who prefer the convenience of digital tools, D&D Beyond offers a robust and user-friendly character creation experience. With intuitive interfaces and helpful prompts, this online

tool streamlines the process of building your character, guiding you through each step with ease. From selecting your race and class to customizing your abilities and equipment, D&D Beyond provides a seamless and efficient way to bring your character to life. Plus, with built-in access to the vast library of D&D content, including spells, subclasses, and magic items, you'll have everything you need to create a truly unique and memorable hero. So whether you're a veteran player or a newcomer to the world of tabletop gaming, D&D Beyond's Character Creation Tool is your gateway to endless adventures in the realms of fantasy.



Metos

Metos offers a cutting-edge character creation app designed to streamline the process of building your heroes for tabletop adventures. With its sleek interface and intuitive design, Metos makes it easy to bring your characters to life with just a few taps on your mobile device. Whether you're on the go or at home, this app provides a convenient way to create and customize your characters, from choosing your race and class to selecting your skills and equipment. With features like built-in dice rolling and real-time updates, Metos ensures that your character creation experience is as seamless and immersive as possible. So why wait? Dive into the world of tabletop gaming with Metos and unleash your imagination like never before.



Flapkan

Flapkan revolutionizes character creation with its automated character sheet service, offering a hassle-free solution for players eager to jump into their adventures. With Flapkan, gone are the days of manual data entry and tedious calculations. Simply input your character's details, and let Flapkan do the rest. From generating ability scores and calculating modifiers to tracking hit points and managing inventory, this service handles all the heavy lifting, allowing you to focus on the excitement of your tabletop journey. With its user-friendly interface and customizable options, Flapkan ensures that your character sheet is always up-to-date and tailored to your preferences. So why waste time with paperwork when you can let Flapkan streamline your character creation process and get you into the game faster than ever before?



Rule Variants

Rule variants are optional modifications and adjustments to the standard rules of a tabletop roleplaying game, offering players and dungeon masters the opportunity to customize their gaming experience. These variants can range from minor tweaks to major overhauls, allowing for greater flexibility and creativity in gameplay. Whether you're looking to add complexity to combat encounters, introduce new character options, or explore different narrative structures, rule variants provide a wealth of possibilities for enhancing your tabletop adventures. In this section, we'll explore some of the most popular rule variants and how they can be used to tailor your game to suit your group's preferences and playstyle. So whether you're a seasoned veteran seeking new challenges or a newcomer looking to experiment with different mechanics, rule variants offer endless opportunities for exploration and innovation in the world of tabletop gaming.

Spellpoints

Spell points offer an alternative method for managing spellcasting resources in Dungeons & Dragons, providing greater flexibility and customization for spellcasters. Instead of using spell slots of various levels, spellcasters are granted a pool of spell points that they can expend to cast spells of any level they have access to. This system allows spellcasters to mix and match spells of different levels more freely, empowering them to adapt to changing situations and cast spells of higher levels when needed without being restricted by predefined slots. In this section, we'll delve into the mechanics of spell points, discuss their advantages and drawbacks, and explore how they can be implemented in your D&D campaigns to enhance the spellcasting experience for players and dungeon masters alike. Whether you're a sorcerer seeking greater versatility or a dungeon

master looking to shake up the traditional magic system, spell points offer a dynamic and engaging alternative that can breathe new life into your tabletop adventures.

You can learn more about spell points in Dungeons & Dragons by referring to official supplementary materials such as the Dungeon Master's Guide (5th edition). Additionally, various online resources, forums, and community discussions offer insights, guides, and homebrew rule variants related to spell points. Experimenting with spell points in your own games and discussing experiences with fellow players and dungeon masters can also provide valuable knowledge and understanding of how spell points function in practice.



Question Mark on Chalk Board

Ability Score Generation Methods

- The Standard Array method provides a balanced and straightforward approach to ability score generation. With this method, players allocate a set of predetermined ability scores to their character, typically consisting of 15, 14, 13, 12, 10, and 8. This method ensures that all characters start with relatively equal capabilities, promoting balance and fairness among the party members.
- Point Buy is a customizable method that

allows players to allocate a pool of points to their ability scores according to predefined costs. Players begin with a set number of points, such as 27 or 32, and spend these points to increase their ability scores. Each ability score increase has a corresponding point cost, with higher scores requiring more points to increase. This method offers flexibility and allows players to tailor their characters' abilities to suit their preferences.

- Rolling Dice involves randomly generating ability scores by rolling dice, such as six-sided dice (d6), and assigning the results to each ability score in order. Common methods include rolling 4d6 and dropping the lowest die, repeating this process six times to generate a set of ability scores. While rolling dice can lead to characters with varied and unpredictable abilities, it also carries the risk of creating characters with exceptionally high or low scores, potentially leading to imbalanced gameplay.
- Beyond the standard methods, players and dungeon masters can also devise custom ability score generation methods tailored to their campaign's needs. This could involve variations of the above methods or entirely new approaches, such as using cards, random tables, or collaborative storytelling exercises to determine ability scores.

Each ability score generation method offers its own benefits and drawbacks, and the choice of method can significantly impact the dynamics of the game. Whether you prefer the consistency of the Standard Array, the customization of Point Buy, the excitement of rolling dice, or the creativity of custom methods, selecting the right method for your campaign ensures a satisfying and enjoyable character creation experience for all players involved.

Ability Score Generation Resources

- [Point buy calculator](#)
- [Standard Array](#)
- [Dice Roller](#)

Critical Hits and Fumbles

Critical hits and fumbles add excitement and unpredictability to combat encounters in Dungeons & Dragons, providing opportunities for thrilling successes and catastrophic failures. While the standard rules for critical hits and fumbles are simple—rolling a natural 20 on an attack roll results in a critical hit, and rolling a natural 1 results in a fumble—many players and dungeon masters prefer to incorporate variant rules to enhance the drama and tension of combat. Let's delve into some common variant rules for critical hits and fumbles:

Some variant rules expand upon the standard critical hit rules by introducing additional effects or bonuses for critical hits. For example, a critical hit might deal double damage as usual, but also cause the target to suffer a status effect such as bleeding, stunned, or knocked prone. These additional effects can make critical hits feel more impactful and rewarding for players.

Critical hit tables provide a randomized list of effects that occur when a critical hit is scored, adding an element of unpredictability to combat. These tables might include effects such as severing a limb, shattering an opponent's weapon, or causing a massive explosion. Critical hit tables can inject excitement and narrative flair into combat encounters, but they also require additional bookkeeping and can result in highly variable outcomes.

In addition to standard fumbles, where a natural 1 on an attack roll results in an automatic miss,

variant rules for fumbles introduce consequences or penalties for critical failures. For example, a fumble might cause the attacker to accidentally strike an ally, drop their weapon, or provoke an opportunity attack from their opponent. Fumble consequences add an element of risk and consequence to combat, encouraging players to think carefully before taking risky actions.

Some variant rules give players more agency over critical hits and fumbles by allowing them to choose or customize the effects that occur. For example, players might have a list of potential critical hit effects to choose from, or they might be able to spend resources such as inspiration points to mitigate the consequences of a fumble. These rules empower players to shape the narrative of combat and take a more active role in determining the outcomes of their actions.

Whether you prefer the simplicity of the standard critical hit and fumble rules or the added depth and complexity of variant rules, incorporating critical hit and fumble rules into your game can make combat encounters more dynamic and memorable. Experiment with different rules and find the ones that best suit your group's playstyle and preferences, and prepare for epic triumphs and disastrous failures on the battlefield.

Exploration and Travel

Exploration and travel are integral aspects of many Dungeons & Dragons campaigns, offering opportunities for discovery, adventure, and world-building. While the standard rules provide a framework for handling exploration and travel, dungeon masters often incorporate variant rules to add depth and realism to these aspects of gameplay. Let's delve into some common variant rules for exploration and travel:

Variant rules for supply management introduce mechanics for tracking food, water, and other essential resources during overland journeys. Characters must manage their supplies carefully,

ensuring they have enough provisions to sustain themselves throughout their travels. Running out of supplies can lead to exhaustion, starvation, and other hazards, adding a layer of challenge and realism to travel.

Variant rules for environmental hazards introduce challenges such as extreme weather, natural disasters, and hazardous terrain during overland journeys. Characters must contend with blistering heat, freezing cold, torrential rain, treacherous terrain, and other environmental dangers as they traverse the wilderness. These hazards can impede progress, inflict damage, and force characters to make difficult decisions to ensure their survival.

Variant rules for random encounters provide guidelines for generating spontaneous encounters with creatures, NPCs, and other elements during overland journeys. These encounters might involve friendly travelers, hostile monsters, mysterious landmarks, or unexpected events that add excitement and unpredictability to travel. Random encounters can help bring the world to life and provide opportunities for roleplaying, combat, and exploration.

Variant rules for exploration activities introduce mechanics for engaging in specific tasks and activities during exploration, such as foraging for food, scouting ahead for threats, navigating difficult terrain, or mapping uncharted territory. Characters can use their skills and abilities to overcome obstacles, gather information, and uncover secrets as they explore the world around them. Exploration activities encourage players to immerse themselves in the role of their characters and interact with the environment in meaningful ways.

Whether you're navigating treacherous wilderness, delving into ancient ruins, or charting unexplored territories, variant rules for exploration and travel can enrich your Dungeons & Dragons campaign by adding depth, challenge, and immersion to the journey. Experiment with different

rules and find the ones that best suit your group's playstyle and preferences, and prepare for epic adventures on the road less traveled.

Skills and Feats

Skills and feats play a crucial role in defining a character's abilities and specialties in Dungeons & Dragons. While the standard rules provide a robust framework for skills and feats, dungeon masters and players often explore variant rules to customize and expand upon these mechanics. Let's delve into some common variant rules for skills and feats:

Variant rules for skill proficiency offer alternative methods for determining a character's proficiency with skills. Instead of relying solely on class and background features to grant proficiency in certain skills, these rules might allow players to choose their proficiency from a list of available skills or gain additional proficiencies through training, experience, or story-driven circumstances. This approach gives players more flexibility and agency in customizing their characters' skill sets to suit their preferences and roleplaying concepts.

Variant rules for feats introduce new feats, modify existing feats, or change the way feats are acquired or used in the game. These rules might include additional feats that provide unique abilities, bonuses, or options for characters, as well as adjustments to the feat selection process, such as allowing characters to gain feats at different levels or granting bonus feats based on specific criteria. Feat variants give players more options for customizing their characters' abilities and playstyles, allowing them to further differentiate their characters and tailor them to their individual preferences.

Skill challenges are narrative-driven mechanics that allow players to use their skills to overcome obstacles, accomplish goals, or navigate complex situations. Instead of relying solely on combat encounters to drive the action, skill challenges encourage players to engage with the game world

through roleplaying and problem-solving, using their characters' skills and abilities to achieve objectives and advance the story. Skill challenges can be used to resolve a wide range of scenarios, from persuading a noble to granting an audience to navigating a treacherous mountain pass, and they provide opportunities for creative thinking and collaboration among players.

Variant rules for skill specializations allow characters to specialize in specific skills, gaining additional benefits or bonuses when using those skills. Characters might choose one or more skills to specialize in, granting them advantages such as increased proficiency bonus, additional abilities, or unique options for using those skills in different situations. Skill specializations encourage players to focus on developing their characters' strengths and expertise in particular areas, rewarding specialization with increased effectiveness and versatility in those skills.

Whether you're seeking to expand the options available for skills and feats, introduce new mechanics for resolving skill-based challenges, or customize your characters' abilities to better reflect their individual personalities and backgrounds, variant rules for skills and feats offer a wealth of possibilities for enhancing your Dungeons & Dragons experience. Experiment with different rules and find the ones that best suit your group's playstyle and preferences, and prepare for epic adventures filled with daring feats of skill and cunning strategies.

Player Tips and Tricks

Player Tips and Tricks

The Player Tips and Tricks section is dedicated to helping players enhance their Dungeons & Dragons gameplay experience and become more effective and engaged participants in their tabletop adventures. Whether you're a seasoned adventurer or new to the game, these tips and strategies are

designed to help you make the most out of your character and contribute to the overall success of your party.

By incorporating these tips and strategies into your gameplay, you can become a more effective and engaged player, enriching your Dungeons & Dragons experience and contributing to the success and enjoyment of your gaming group. So sharpen your swords, ready your spells, and embark on epic adventures filled with excitement, challenge, and camaraderie!

Character Optimization

- Choose race and class combinations that complement each other and fit your character concept.
- Prioritize abilities that align with your character's strengths and playstyle.
- Consider multiclassing to gain access to additional abilities and features that synergize well with your character's build.

Roleplaying Guidance

- Create a detailed backstory for your character to provide context and motivation for their actions.
- Embrace your character's personality traits, flaws, and ideals, and incorporate them into your roleplaying interactions.
- Listen actively to other players' roleplaying moments and respond in-character to foster immersive storytelling experiences.

Effective Communication

- Clearly communicate your character's intentions and actions during gameplay to avoid confusion and streamline decision-making.
- Use non-verbal cues, such as hand gestures or facial expressions, to enhance communication with other players.

- Respect other players' input and opinions, and collaborate with them to achieve common goals and objectives.

Combat Tactics

- Position yourself strategically on the battlefield to maximize your effectiveness and minimize risk.
- Coordinate with your teammates to focus fire on priority targets and exploit enemy vulnerabilities.
- Use your character's abilities and resources judiciously, saving powerful spells and abilities for critical moments in combat encounters.
- Problem-Solving Skills:
 - Think creatively and explore alternative solutions when faced with challenges or obstacles.
 - Use your character's skills and abilities to gather information, assess situations, and devise effective strategies for overcoming obstacles.
- Work collaboratively with your fellow players to brainstorm ideas and leverage each other's strengths to find solutions to difficult puzzles or dilemmas.

Table Etiquette

- Respect the duneon master's authority and follow their rulings, even if they differ from your expectations or preferences.
- Avoid interrupting or talking over other players during roleplaying scenes or combat encounters.
- Be mindful of your table manners, including keeping distractions to a minimum and maintaining a positive and respectful attitude towards your fellow players..

Credits

Edited and Published by James R Mann

Images

Images not produced for this magazine were sourced from [Pexels.com](https://www.pexels.com/), and [Images.nasa.gov](https://images.nasa.gov/). Screenshots were created by James R Mann for educational purposes.

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Illustrations for this magazine were created by James R Mann using Adobe Photoshop, vector assets made in Adobe Illustrator.

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- [The Forgotten Realms Wiki](#)
- [Dnd Beyond Forums](#)